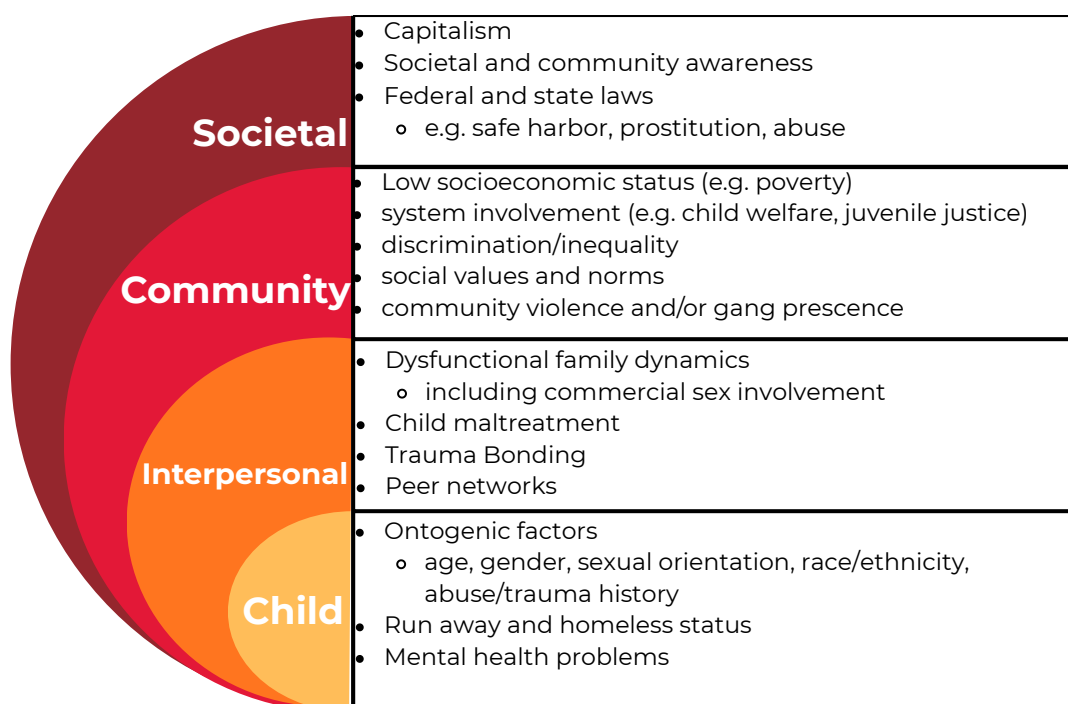


Understanding Risk Through a Social Ecological Lens

How multiple contexts influence vulnerability to sex trafficking

- Children and youth are **embedded within systems**, including their home and school environments, which are most immediate, as well as in the larger society.
- A youth's personal attributes intersect with their systems to **influence risk for trafficking**.
- Please keep these systems in mind when completing the York Sex Trafficking Screening Tool.

Fig. 1 Traumagenic social ecological framework for child sex trafficking



Example

A youth flagged for running away may not be at high risk alone, but combined with family conflict, system involvement, and community instability, **vulnerability increases significantly**.

Using The YST

- Consider factors across **multiple levels**
- Avoid focusing only on individual behaviour
- Look for patterns **across systems**

References

Finigan-Carr, N.M., Johnson, M.H., Pullmann, M.D. et al. A Traumagenic Social Ecological Framework for Understanding and Intervening with Sex Trafficked Children and Youth. *Child Adolesc Soc Work J* 36, 49–63 (2019). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10560-018-0588-7>